

07 External Gym Membership and Collections Report

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Prepared by Fictional independent industry research desk

SYNTHETIC DEMO. Entirely fictional research and events; no actual industry survey was conducted.

Research scope

Synthetic note by the Fictional Local Fitness Research Desk, dated December 7, 2026. A fictional panel of 60 independent gym operators submitted anonymized October-November payment and membership summaries. The sample is not representative of the national market and no chain is identified.

Observations

Thirty-three of 60 operators reported more first-attempt recurring-payment failures in November than October. Of these 33, nineteen said at least half the failed amount was recovered within seven days. Twenty-four of all 60 reported higher membership cancellations. The note does not link the same customers to both observations.

Possible effects and limits

A failed first payment can delay collections without canceling a membership or permanently reducing revenue. Rising cancellations can reduce future billings even where remaining-member collections remain strong. Local labor and occupancy costs may limit an operator's ability to reduce spending quickly. These are possible mechanisms, not proof of a particular company's result. No payment-network rule, consumer-credit law or public-company financing event is reported.

Evidence required

Use a consistent club perimeter, opening members, joins, effective cancellations, bills, cleared receipts and receivables aging. Distinguish current-month dues from recovery of earlier arrears. Foot traffic and total sign-ups alone do not establish retention or cash conversion.